



Reclassified, Not Reconciled

What the Capability Sprints' Capacity Reconciliation Index Actually Tracks

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Background

The Capability Sprints' new Capacity Reconciliation Index folds an enrolment cap and a University growth target into one composite score. Little is known about what a program measured by two irreconcilable mandates from the same headcount actually does to satisfy both.

Aims

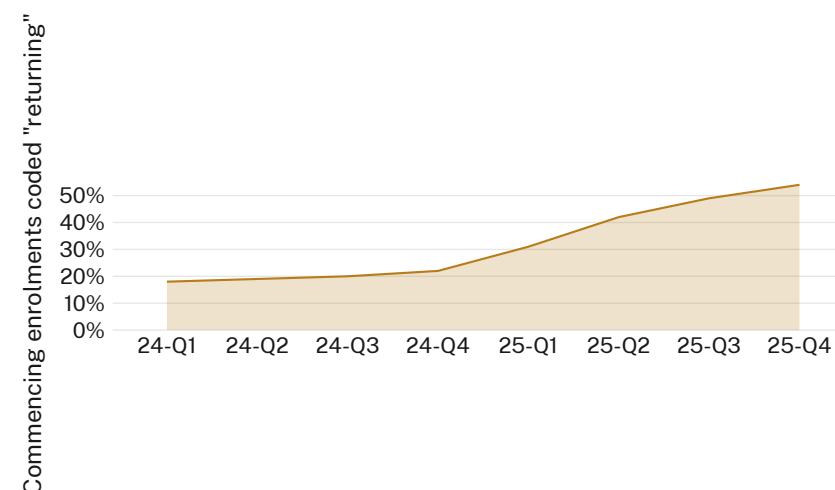
- Test whether the Index tracks seats the program can actually run
- Identify what administrative behaviour raises the Index score
- Compare the Index's trajectory against unchanged physical capacity

Methods

- n = 5 Sprints × 8 intakes (40 intake-cycles), 2024–2026
- Index scores cross-read against enrolment-system classification logs
- Classification thresholds and Index formula held constant throughout

Results

The Index's steady climb toward its published target tracks almost entirely with a rising share of commencing enrolments coded "returning" rather than "new". Seats actually offered across the five Sprints show no corresponding change over the same window.



Commencing enrolments coded "returning" rose from 22% to 54% across the two intakes following the Index's Q1 2025 launch (n = 40 intake-cycles); seats offered held flat at 30 per intake throughout.

Discussion & conclusions

The Index rises fastest where reclassification is cheapest — a seat freed by relabelling never actually opens. Next: audit classification against enrolment-history records, not the self-reported field.

References

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Enrolment-classification logs analysed in de-identified, aggregate form only; no student records retained.

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“The count balanced. The seats didn’t.”

Returning-enrolment coding rose from 22% to 54% within two intakes of the Index's Q1 2025 launch (n = 40 intake-cycles).